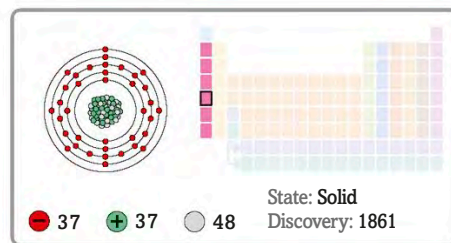


37
Rb

Rubidium



Forms



Pale, waxy mineral

Leucite



This soft mineral contains up to 3.5% rubidium.



Rubidium makes up only about **1 per cent** of this mineral.

This glass case contains pure rubidium, preventing it from coming into contact with air and catching fire.

This ore contains caesium and rubidium.



Rubidium was named after the Latin word *rubidius*, meaning “deepest red”. This refers to the red-coloured flame it produces when burned. This highly reactive element ignites on contact with air. On contact with water, it reacts vigorously, producing hydrogen gas and a lot of

heat. Rubidium is not often concentrated in particular minerals, but instead is spread in small amounts through a wide range of minerals, such as **leucite** and **pollucite**. The pure metal is sourced mainly from the mineral **lepidolite**. Another mineral called rubicline has even more